Strategic Learning: How Strategic is *Your* Plan?

Objective: To explore your own strategic plan and compare your analysis with that of a colleagues and based on your discussions to gain insights which could be used to enhance the value of your own strategic plan.

Process: Take 10 mins or so to review your own plan. Then working in pairs please compare your responses. In each case use the framework below to try and identify how strategic you feel your plan is and what new insights you can gain from that of your colleague.

Based on the exercise try and conclude by identifying at least 2 actions which you could implement to further enhance the strategic nature of your current plan.

1. Strategic Thinking: Anticipating *'there'* – Analysis and Horizon Scanning

- Does the plan demonstrate clear evidence of the ***changes*** occurring in the external environment?
  - Political
  - Economic?
  - Social?
  - Technological?
  - Legal?
  - Environmental?
- Does the plan consider some of the possible ***future scenarios*** which might you might face in the delivery of oral health/oral health education or does it appear to neglect consideration of critical uncertainties which could occur?

1. Limited evidence, appears reactive to external conditions.

10. Highly strategic pro-actively responsive to external conditions.

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10

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2. Strategic Positioning: Being *'there'* – Making Choices

- Does the plan clearly articulate an ***overall vision*** for the delivery of oral health/oral health education?
- Do you have a sense from the plan that the document highlights the ***key strategic dilemmas*** facing those responsible for the delivery of oral health/oral health education?
- Does the plan provide adequate evidence of ***clear choices*** being made to ensure effective delivery of oral health/oral health education?

1. Limited evidence, appears to be very similar to many other plans

10. Highly strategic clearly articulated and differentiated vision.

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10

3. Strategic Change Management: Getting to *'there'* – Implementation

- Does the plan consider the ***resource*** implications of the strategy/vision adequately? (or do you have evidence that this is being considered elsewhere)?
- Are the ***resource implications*** clearly linked/alignment to the strategy?
- How clear is the plan for ***executing*** each component of the strategy?
- Are the ***structural implications*** of the strategy considered?
- Do processes exist so that the plan can ***adapt and change*** to changing circumstances?

1. Limited evidence, implementation seems disconnected from the strategy

10. Highly strategic clear links between strategy and implementation.

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10

4. Strategic Performance Measurement: Measuring *'there'* – Key Performance Indicators

- Do a clear set of ***measurable criteria*** exist which define success for the plan?
- Does the plan have clear ***metrics*** which guide the implementation of the strategy?
- Do you sense that consideration has been given to how to ***link performance measurement*** at a national level to those at a local level or at an organisational level to those within your Department/Division?

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1. Limited evidence, very few (if any) measures of success, rarely reviewed.

10. Highly strategic clear and well connected and reviewed KPIs

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10

5. Strategic Communication & Engagement : Communicating (and integrating) *'there'* – Key Messages

- Does the plan convey sufficiently clearly a set of the ***key strategic messages***?
- Is the plan/approach to planning adequately ***integrated***, or a series of largely unconnected parts?
- Do you have a clear sense of how the plan is being ***communicated?***
- Could you easily ***convey the essence of the plan*** to an influential stakeholder (say the Minister of Health or Education?)

1. Limited evidence, contradictory and confused series of messages

10. Highly strategic clear and consistent set of strategic priorities

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10

6. Strategic Team Working: Focused Energy towards getting *'there'*

- Do you get the impression that the plan/approach to planning is genuinely the work of, and ***has involved a range of stakeholders,*** in its development (i.e. it has not just been written by one person and announced)?
- Can you see adequate evidence of the extent to which ***the responsible Minister and or Institutional Leader is personally fully committed*** to making the plan happen?
- Can you judge to what extent the ***senior management team of the Oral Health Service/Dental School are also committed*** to the delivery of the plan?
- Do you sense that a significant numbers of staff (at all levels) are ***actively engaged*** in delivering specific actions which will ensure the plan is delivered within the time horizon which has been set?

1. Limited commitment, very little engagement in either development or delivery

10. Highly strategic, high level of engagement in both development & delivery

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10

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7. Strategic Disinvestment: Clearing the way to get to *'there'*

- Do you see evidence of the strategic ***priorities being re-evaluated***?
- Does the plan identify activities to ***stop?***
- Does the plan recognise the need to ensure people and resources will need to be ***re-deployed?***
- Do you sense that adequate ***leadership capacity*** exists to ensure disinvestment and redeployment activities can be undertaken swiftly?

1. No reprioritisation, of activities, just a wish list

10. Effective reassessment of priorities including stopping activity and disinvesting from certain areas

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10

8. Strategic Innovation: Finding new ways to *'get to there'*

- Can you find examples where ***real innovations in practice*** either through the development, delivery, processes, products or technology?
- Does the plan seem to be anticipating how to respond to ***major disruptive innovations***, or somewhat unaware or complacent in relation to the impact of these external forces?
- Do you sense the ***culture*** within which the plan has been developed is conducive and encourages the development of innovative ideas?
- Do you sense that the engagement with staff will enable the ***leadership of innovation*** to flourish or might the leadership processes constrain innovation?

1. Little innovation, just more of the same, culture constrains new ideas and ways of operating

10. Extremely innovative processes and culture which encourage and values new ideas and challenges to existing practices and orthodoxies.

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10

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<u>Strategic Emergence</u>: Appropriate Balance of 'Explicit' and 'Emergent' Strategies

- Do you get the impression that the plan is adequately responsive and will be able to ***flexibly adapt*** to changing external conditions or internal priorities?
- Is the plan ***too 'opportunistic' or too 'centrally planned'***?
- Do you sense that the right processes exist which would enable changes to be influenced through ***'bottom-up' engagement***, or are the processes heavily dependent on a few senior staff?

1. Too opportunistic, highly dependent on 'emergence'	*About right*	*10. Too centrally planned, too highly dependent on the 'explicit' plan*

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10

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Summary and Conclusions

- **Overall Score**

Issue	Score
1. Strategic Thinking: Anticipating *'there'*	
2. Strategic Positioning: Being *'there'*	
3. Strategic Change Management: Getting to *'there'*	**(x 2)**
4. Strategic Performance Measurement: Measuring *'there'*	
5. Strategic Communication & Engagement: Communication (and integrating) '*there'*	
6. Strategic Team Working: Focused energy to getting *'there'*	
7. Strategic Disinvestment: Clearing the way to get to *'there'*	**(x2)**
8. Strategic Innovation: Finding new ways to *'get to there'*	
TOTAL *(maximum 100)*	
Strategic Emergence: Appropriate balance of 'explicit and 'emergent' strategies	

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<u>Strategic Learning</u>: Action Planning

- What 1 or 2 ***areas*** does your review highlight as possible issues where further work is required to enhance the strategic nature of your current plan?

1. ……

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2. ……

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